

English Ladder

Student Workbook

Concept #09: Causal Phrases

A polished self-study handout designed for print or tablet use. Read the concept, notice the pattern, and then complete the matching practice set on your own.



Grammar Concepts #09	Key Points	Sentence Styles and Phrases	Examples and Explanations	Additional Examples
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Visual anchor

Use the concept poster to spotlight the main language pattern in **Concept #09: Causal Phrases** and keep the explanation visible during practice and discussion.

ENGLISH LADDER

Concept #09 ► Causal Phrases

There are 3 basic sentence styles used to communicate causation.

Causal Direction: A ► B
Cause Effect

① A. ____ B. ② A ____ B. ③ B ____ A.

This causes	causes	is caused by
This creates	creates	is created by
This produces	produces	is produced by
This leads to	leads to	is a product of
As a result,	results in	is a result of
This results in		is due to
Consequently,		is a consequence of

Examples:

1: I gamble. This has led to my poverty.
2: My gambling has led to my poverty.
3: My poverty is due to my gambling.

affects 0.1%-99% — Is a contributing cause
effects 100% — Is the single cause (scientific)

 **results in** 

Others: Due to A, B. | As a result of A, B. | The effect of A is B.

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Core Idea

Causal phrases are used to communicate the cause and effect relationship between two actions or events. This concept is essential for conveying how one event leads to another. There are three basic sentence styles used to express causation:

Key Points

- A causes B
- A is caused by B
- B is caused by A

Causal Direction: A ➡■ B (Cause ➡■ Effect)

Let's explore the different ways to express causation in English, as illustrated in the image.

Sentence Styles and Phrases

1. A causes B

In this structure, the first event (A) causes the second event (B). This is a direct way to show causation.

- This causes: "The heavy rain causes flooding in the area."
- This creates: "Pollution creates health problems for many people."
- This produces: "The new policy produces positive outcomes for the company."
- This leads to: "Lack of exercise leads to obesity."
- As a result: "The team worked hard. As a result, they won the championship."
- This results in: "The accident results in traffic delays."
- Consequently: "The company failed to innovate. Consequently, it went bankrupt."

2. A is caused by B

In this structure, the second event (B) is the cause of the first event (A). This is useful for emphasizing the cause.

- Is caused by: "Flooding is caused by heavy rain."
- Is created by: "Health problems are created by pollution."
- Is produced by: "Positive outcomes are produced by the new policy."
- Is a product of: "Obesity is a product of lack of exercise."



- Is a result of: "The championship win is a result of the team's hard work."
- Is due to: "Traffic delays are due to the accident."
- Is a consequence of: "The bankruptcy is a consequence of the company's failure to innovate."

3. B is caused by A

This structure is less common but still important. It is often used in scientific or technical contexts to describe results.

- Is affected by: "The climate is affected by greenhouse gas emissions."
- Is a contributing cause of: "Smoking is a contributing cause of lung cancer."

Examples and Explanation

Style 1: A causes B

- Sentence: "The sun causes plants to grow."
- Explanation: The sun (A) is the cause, and the growth of plants (B) is the effect.
- Sentence: "Poor diet leads to health issues."
- Explanation: A poor diet (A) causes health issues (B).

Style 2: A is caused by B

- Sentence: "Plants' growth is caused by the sun."
- Explanation: The growth of plants (A) is caused by the sun (B).
- Sentence: "Health issues are due to a poor diet."
- Explanation: Health issues (A) are due to a poor diet (B).

Style 3: B is caused by A

- Sentence: "The growth of plants is a result of sunlight."
- Explanation: The growth of plants (B) is a result of sunlight (A).
- Sentence: "Health problems are a consequence of poor nutrition."
- Explanation: Health problems (B) are a consequence of poor nutrition (A).

Additional Examples

- Due to A, B.
- Sentence: "Due to the rain, the match was postponed."
- Explanation: The match was postponed (B) due to the rain (A).



- As a result of A, B.
- Sentence: "As a result of the new law, many businesses had to close."
- Explanation: Many businesses had to close (B) as a result of the new law (A).
- The effect of A is B.
- Sentence: "The effect of global warming is more extreme weather conditions."
- Explanation: More extreme weather conditions (B) are the effect of global warming (A).

Conclusion

Understanding and using causal phrases correctly helps in clearly conveying the cause and effect relationship in sentences. This is particularly important in both spoken and written English for explaining processes, giving reasons, and discussing results. By practicing these structures, non-native speakers can improve their ability to express complex ideas effectively.

Practice Exercises

- Create sentences using "This causes," "As a result," and "Consequently."
- Rewrite the following sentences to use the "is caused by" structure:
- "The company's success is due to its innovative products."
- "Obesity is a result of poor dietary habits."
- Use the "Due to A, B" structure in your own sentences.

By practicing these exercises, you can become more comfortable with expressing causation in English.



Practice Check

Answer the quiz questions below with the best causal terms. (For some items, both options may be correct.)

ITEM 01

The heavy rain _____ flooding in the area.

- a) causes
- b) is caused by

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 02

Flooding in the area _____ the heavy rain.

- a) causes
- b) is caused by

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 03

Lack of exercise _____ obesity.

- a) leads to
- b) is led by

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 04

Obesity _____ lack of exercise.

- a) leads to
- b) is a product of

Correct choice: _____

**ITEM 05**

Pollution _____ **health problems.**

- a) creates
- b) is created by

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 06

Health problems _____ **pollution.**

- a) creates
- b) are created by

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 07

The new policy _____ **positive outcomes for the company.**

- a) produces
- b) is produced by

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 08

Positive outcomes for the company _____ **the new policy.**

- a) produces
- b) are produced by

Correct choice: _____

**ITEM 09**

Hard work _____ success.

a) leads to

b) is a result of

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 10

Success _____ hard work.

a) leads to

b) is a result of

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 11

The accident _____ traffic delays.

a) results in

b) is a result of

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 12

Traffic delays _____ the accident.

a) results in

b) are a result of

Correct choice: _____

**ITEM 13**

The team worked hard. _____, they won the championship.

a) As a result

b) Due to

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 14

The championship win _____ the team's hard work.

a) is a result of

b) results in

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 15

The company's failure to innovate _____ bankruptcy.

a) results in

b) is due to

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 16

The bankruptcy _____ the company's failure to innovate.

a) results in

b) is due to

Correct choice: _____

**ITEM 17**

Global warming _____ more extreme weather conditions.

- a) causes
- b) is a consequence of

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 18

More extreme weather conditions _____ global warming.

- a) causes
- b) are a consequence of

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 19

The pollution _____ health problems in the city.

- a) leads to
- b) is led by

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 20

Health problems in the city _____ pollution.

- a) lead to
- b) are led by

Correct choice: _____

**ITEM 21**

The lack of funding _____ the project's failure.

- a) results in
- b) is a result of

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 22

The project's failure _____ the lack of funding.

- a) results in
- b) is a result of

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 23

The new technology _____ increased productivity.

- a) produces
- b) is produced by

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 24

Increased productivity _____ the new technology.

- a) produces
- b) is produced by

Correct choice: _____



Self-check Answer Key

Use the key after you have completed every item on your own.

ITEM 01

The heavy rain causes flooding in the area.

ITEM 02

Flooding in the area is caused by the heavy rain.

ITEM 03

Lack of exercise leads to obesity.

ITEM 04

Obesity is a product of lack of exercise.

ITEM 05

Pollution creates health problems.

ITEM 06

Health problems are created by pollution.

ITEM 07

The new policy produces positive outcomes for the company.

ITEM 08

Positive outcomes for the company are produced by the new policy.

ITEM 09

Hard work leads to success.

ITEM 10

Success is a result of hard work.

ITEM 11

The accident results in traffic delays.

ITEM 12

Traffic delays are a result of the accident.

ITEM 13

The team worked hard. As a result, they won the championship.

ITEM 14

The championship win is a result of the team's hard work.

**ITEM 15**

The company's failure to innovate results in bankruptcy.

ITEM 16

The bankruptcy is due to the company's failure to innovate.

ITEM 17

Global warming causes more extreme weather conditions.

ITEM 18

More extreme weather conditions are a consequence of global warming.

ITEM 19

The pollution leads to health problems in the city.

ITEM 20

Health problems in the city are led by pollution.

ITEM 21

The lack of funding results in the project's failure.

ITEM 22

The project's failure is a result of the lack of funding.

ITEM 23

The new technology produces increased productivity.

ITEM 24

Increased productivity is produced by the new technology.